

Week 6 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 6 · Lixing Lao, Ph.D., L.Ac., MB · Topic: Inspection — Vitality, Color, Sense Organs, Hair/Nails/Skin, Secretions, Pediatric Dx

Study Order — 1) Shen 2) Su Wen 32 face map 3) Five Colors 4) Five Wheels & eye findings 5) other sense organs/tissues 6) secretions + infant vein 7) Constitution (flagged, lowest priority).

1 · Framework	
Method	Uses
Inspection	Eyes: vitality, color, appearance, secretions (incl. tongue)
Auscultation/Olfaction	Ears (listen) + nose (smell)
Inquiry	Verbal questioning
Palpation	Touch, incl. pulse

Quick Recall: Zang-Xiang = inside shows outside.

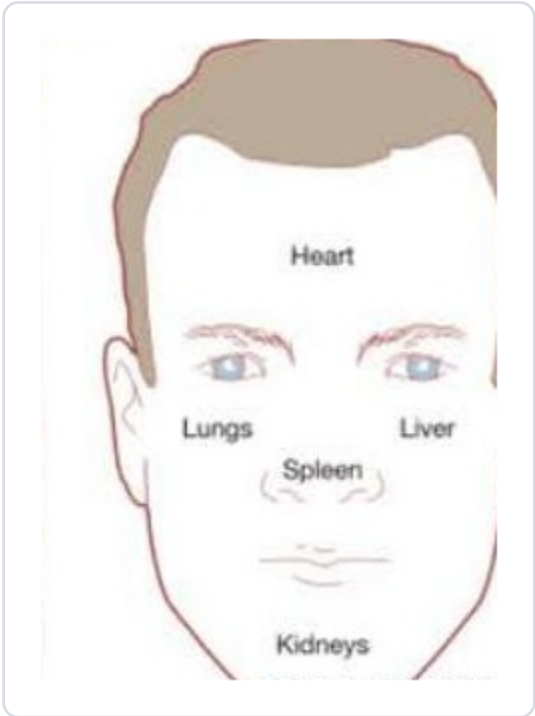
2 · Shen (Vitality)			
Observation	Having Shen	Loss of Shen	False Shen
Complexion	Bright and moist	Dim, dull sheen	Dull, then suddenly lustrous
Eyes	Alert, vivid, twinkle	Dull, blurred vision	Dull, then suddenly bright
Mind/Speech	Clear speech, conscious, agile	Unconscious, delirious	Unclear, then sudden change
Motion/Response	Quick, appropriate	Sluggish and slow	Suddenly responsive
Respiration	Even	Rapid, feeble, or difficult	Feeble, then briefly steady

Heads Up — False Shen = sudden brightening in a critical patient. Warning sign, NOT recovery.

Deranged Shen (shén luàn)

Deranged Shen	Presentation
Fán zào	Irritability + hot/feverish sensation
Zàng zào	Depression, hallucination, crying spells, no LOC
Bái hé bìng	Chronic depression, mumbling, insomnia, sleepwalking
Diān (Yin madness)	Chronic depression, mumbling, inappropriate laugh/cry
Kuáng (Yang madness)	Raving, aggression, wandering naked, obscenities

Su Wen 32 — Face Heat Map



Drawn as if facing the patient — their left cheek is on YOUR right.

Region (patient's own left/right)	Organ
L cheek (patient's)	Liver
Forehead	Heart
Nose	Spleen
R cheek (patient's)	Lung
Chin	Kidney

Quick Recall: Face-forward pictures mirror this — patient's left is on YOUR right.

3 • Five Colors of Face	
Color	Indication
Red	Heat (excess=whole face; malar only=yin-def heat)
Pale/White	Cold, blood/yang deficiency (puffy=yang qi def; withered=blood def)
Yellow	Deficiency, damp (bright=yang jaundice/damp-heat; smoky=yin jaundice)
Blue-Green	Cold, pain, stagnation, convulsion
Dark Grey/Black	Kidney deficiency, blood stasis

Quick Recall: Lustrous=good prognosis. Dark/haggard=poor prognosis.

Heads Up — Homework format = 5-color comparison table w/ case example. Expect similar on quiz.
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Secretions: Color Rule

Finding	Meaning
Clear/white	Deficiency/cold
Turbid/yellow	Excess/heat

4 • Appearance, Body Shape & Movement

Body Shape

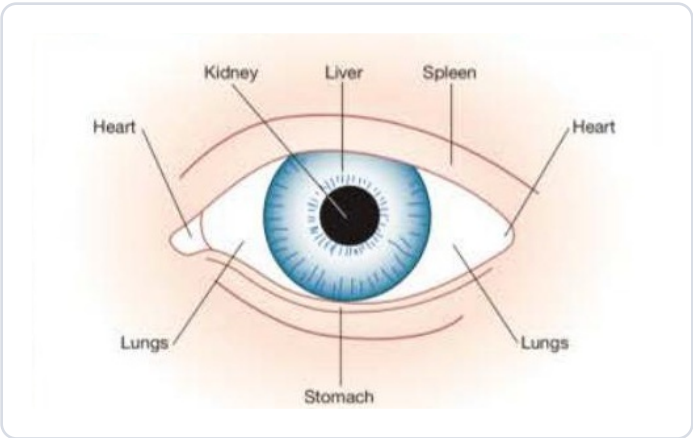
Finding	Pattern
Overweight + depression	Qi deficiency + excess phlegm-damp
Thin person, dry skin	Blood insufficiency
Great weight loss, long illness	Exhaustion of essential Qi
Large barrel chest/epigastrium	Full (excess) lung/stomach condition
Large, overweight thighs	Spleen not transforming/transporting
Thin body overall	Yin deficiency
Overweight body overall	Yang deficiency with phlegm

Movement & Posture

Finding	Pattern
Active movement	Yang syndrome
Passive manner	Yin syndrome
Violent limb movement	Wind disease (tetanus, infantile convulsion)
Muscle weakness/atrophy	Wei syndrome
Pain+swelling+restricted joints	Bi syndrome (painful obstruction)
One-sided numbness	Hemiplegia / wind-stroke
Quick movement + heat	Excess Yang
Slow movement + cold	Yang deficiency
Small, restless fidgeting	Empty (deficiency) heat
Tremors, convulsions	Wind (involuntary movement)
Paralysis	Internal wind
Stiffness/rigidity	Qi stagnation, blood stasis, and/or wind

Quick Recall: Active/fast/hot=Yang excess. Passive/slow/cold=Yang deficiency (NOT Yin deficiency — Yin deficiency causes heat, not cold).

5 • Eyes: Five Wheels



Five Wheels of the Eye — source: Maciocia, The Foundations of Chinese Medicine (3rd ed.), via Prof. Schrier's Week 6 slides. Used for internal class study only.

Wheel	Structure	Organ
Blood	Inner/outer canthus	Heart
Qi	Sclera	Lung
Wind	Iris	Liver
Water	Pupil	Kidney
Flesh	Eyelids (upper=Spleen, lower=Stomach)	Spleen/Stomach

Heads Up — Right Chi pulse = PC/San Jiao, NOT Kidney. Don't confuse w/ eye-wheel Kidney=pupil.

Eye Color

Color	Pattern
Bright yellow (tangerine-peel)	Damp-heat, heat predominant
Dull, dusky yellow	Damp-heat, damp predominant
Dull, dark yellow	Cold-damp
Deep yellow + bloodshot	Toxic heat in the blood level
Dull, dark yellow-brown	Blood stasis (dark rings, purple tongue)
Red (inner/outer canthus)	Heart fire (or SI, if outer canthus)
Red, entire eye + headache	Rising Liver fire
Red sclera, sore throat, cough	Exterior wind-heat affecting Lung
Sudden red + itching + aversion to cold	Exterior invasion of wind-heat
Blue-green	Liver wind (tremor, dizziness, numbness, paralysis)
Bluish	Internal cold, or Kidney Yin deficiency
Dark sclera (crab-eye black)	Accumulated heat
Dark eye sockets, sunken	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency

Color	Pattern
White rings around iris	Turbid phlegm
Cloudy white iris	Liver & Kidney Yin deficiency
Pale white vessels in canthus	Blood or Yang deficiency

Quick Recall: Yellow=damp, Red=heat/fire, Blue-green=wind/cold, Black/dark=extreme heat OR extreme cold, White=deficiency/phlegm.

Eye Shape & Movement

Presentation	Pattern
Bulging/protruding + anger, red tongue, yellow greasy coat	Liver Yang rising w/ heat+damp
Protruding + neck swelling, tinnitus, 5-center heat	Liver Yin def. w/ relative Yang excess
Sunken + slight cough, weak voice	Lung deficiency
Sunken + poor appetite, distention, limb weakness	Spleen deficiency
Sunken, sudden onset, deep/scattered pulse	Yin/Yang collapse (severe)
Swollen, sudden onset, no color change	Fluid malfunction (Spleen def. w/ damp)
Bags under the eyes	Spleen & Kidney deficiency
Strabismus, sudden, no redness/swelling	Wind attacking channels
Deviation + nausea, vomiting, greasy coat	Wind-damp-phlegm obstruction
Both eyes deviate up/high fever/coma	Extreme heat generating wind
Deviation after trauma	Blood stasis
Congenital deviation	Essence deficiency (Kidney)
Frequent spasms, dry itchy eyes, pale, thready pulse	Blood deficiency

Presentation	Pattern
Eyelids heavy/tired feeling	Spleen Qi deficiency
Occasional spasm + red/itchy + fever/chills	Exterior invasion (wind-heat)
Droopy eyelids (ptosis)	Qi sinking, or wind attacking channels

6 • Nose

Lung (5-phase) + Spleen (facial map, both Su Wen & Ling Shu).

Finding	Pattern
Green/blue tip	Cold
Yellow tip	Damp (+heat if thirst/sweat)
White tip	Blood deficiency
Red tip	Heat
Gray tip	Impaired water → edema
Green bridge	Liver Qi stagnation
Dark purple bridge	Blood stasis
Red bridge	Liver fire
Dry and black	Toxic heat
Flaring nostrils	Extreme heat
Epistaxis	Excess heat, blood forced out
Swollen nose	Excess condition
Sunken nose	Deficiency condition

Finding	Pattern
Nasal polyps	Stagnated heat in Yangming channel

Quick Recall: Normal nose = slightly moist and shiny.

Edema Location

Edema Starts In	Organ
Upper body/head	Lung
Lower body/feet	Kidney
4 limbs/torso	Spleen

7 • Ears

Kidney opens to ear.

Finding	Pattern
Swelling/pain, middle ear	Heat in the Shaoyang
Dry/withered/black auricle, chronic illness	Kidney essence exhausted
Purulent discharge ("Tin Er")	Damp-heat Liver/GB
Thin ear	Qi/Blood deficiency
Long, full earlobes	Strong constitution
Small earlobes	Poor constitution
Shiny, moist earlobes	Good prognosis
Dry, withered earlobes	Poor prognosis / Kidney Qi exhaustion
Yellow/white pus discharge	Kidney Yin def. w/ fire, or Liver/GB damp-heat
Ear color: white	Sudden wind-cold invasion
Ear color: green/black	Pain
Ear color: black	Kidney failure
Ear color: red	Excess heat (possibly damp-heat)

Finding	Pattern
Ear color: yellow	Damp accumulation

Tinnitus	Organ
High-pitch (cicada)	Liver
Low-pitch (water)	Kidney

8 • Teeth

Kidney — teeth are the "surplus of bone."

Finding	Pattern
White, moist, bright/clean	Strong Kidney Qi
Dry, no sheen	Kidney Yin decline
Yellowing, gradual w/ age	Normal aging
Sudden dull yellow (soybean)	Kidney deficiency
Gray and black (black bean)	Exhaustion of Yin and Yang
Dry, black, gray	Kidney Yin deficiency
Tartar, grimy yellow	Stomach turbidity
Burnt and dry	Kidney & Stomach Yin deficiency
Delayed baby/adult teeth	Essence and Jing deficiency
Deviated growth / missing	Insufficient Yangming Qi
Loss of teeth in adult, receding gums	Fire flaring up from Kidney Yin def.

Gums (Spleen/Stomach)

Finding	Pattern
Moist, deep red (normal)	Normal
Deep red + swelling	Excess heat / Stomach fire
Pale	Blood deficiency
Atrophied	Kidney deficiency
Blue line between teeth/gums	Mercury poisoning
Swollen, ulcerated, bleeding	Stomach fire pushing blood out

Lips & Mouth (Spleen)

Finding	Pattern
Pale lips	Blood deficiency
Blue-purplish lips	Retention of cold OR blood stagnation
Bright red lips	Heat toxins
Crimson lips	Yin-deficiency heat
Dry, red lips	Heat damaging fluids
Purple lips	Blood stasis (stabbing pain)
Deviated mouth	Wind
Mouth slightly open	Deficiency pattern
Mouth remains open + fever/thirst/canker sores	Excess heat
Breathing through open mouth	Empty/deficiency pattern
Open mouth + SOB + frothy sputum	Lung deficiency w/ phlegm stagnation
Sudden attack, drooling, LOC	Wind

Throat & Tonsils (Stomach+Lung)

Finding	Pattern
Deep red throat/pharynx	Heat
Pale red throat	Empty (deficiency) heat
Acute pain+redness+swelling	Wind invasion (exterior)
Chronic redness/swelling	Interior Stomach heat
Chronic sore/dry, NOT swollen/red	Lung/Kidney Yin def., empty heat
Erosion, redness, swelling, yellowish-red	Heat in Stomach/Intestines
Chronic erosion, comes and goes	Empty (deficiency) heat
Chronic erosion, hard raised ulcers	Blood stasis with phlegm-heat
Swollen tonsils, normal color	Damp/phlegm retention, Qi deficiency bg.
Chronically red/swollen tonsils	Heat or toxic heat, Stomach/LI
Acutely red/swollen tonsils	Wind-heat invasion w/ toxicity
Acute red/swollen with exudate	Heat toxins, Stomach/LI (vs. cold)

9 · Hair

Blood + Kidney Essence. Women ruled by Blood, men by Qi.

Finding	Pattern
Original color, shiny, lustrous, moist	Sufficient Blood/Kidney essence
Premature graying	Depletion of Kidney essence
Dull, brittle, easily broken	Kidney essence or Liver Blood def.
Thick, lustrous	Sufficient Blood/Kidney essence
Thin, sparse	Deficiency of Kidney
Thinning/falling out, general	Blood deficiency
Falling out in patches	Blood deficiency within channels

Nails

Reflect the Liver.

Finding	Pattern
Pink, normal luster	Sufficient Qi
Dark red	Heat
Pale	Blood deficiency or cold
Blanch returns immediately	Sufficient Qi and Blood
Blanch returns slowly	Exhaustion of Qi and Blood
Withered, dried	Liver/Kidney Yin insufficiency; chronic Bi
Atrophied / peeled	Yin deficiency
Soft and thin	Deficiency of Blood
Rough, thick, dull, no transparency	Qi/Blood deficiency with wind
Longitudinal striping	Liver Blood def., trauma, fungal infection
Brittle	Blood deficiency, wind, or trauma
Hook-shaped	Qi/Blood stagnation, wind-Bi
Spoon-shaped	Qi/Blood stag., malnutrition, Spleen def.

Finding	Pattern
Ridged	Kidney Yin def., Liver Yang rising, Blood def.
Bluish thenar veins	Cold in the Stomach
Short bluish thenar veins	Empty (deficiency) pattern
Red thenar veins	Heat
Purple thenar veins	Blood stasis

Skin

Finding	Pattern
Lustrous, harmonious (normal)	Normal
Red	Heat
Yellow, orangish	Damp-heat, more heat than damp
Yellow, dusky	Damp-heat, more damp than heat
Too moist	Lung not controlling fluids
Dry	Blood/fluid deficiency
Dark, with scales	Blood stasis
Itching	Wind
Pitting edema (upper→down)	Yang edema, Spleen/Kidney Yang def.
Non-pitting edema	Qi stagnation or dampness
Edema from feet up, worse below	Yin edema

Skin Lesions

Lesion	Description
Papule	Raised, red, seed-sized; fades w/ pressure
Macule	Flat red patch; does NOT fade w/ pressure
Blister	Fluid-filled, thick or thin walls
Nodule	Palpable, solid, round

Term	Cause
Yong — Yang carbuncle	Internal accumulation of fire toxins
Ju — Yin carbuncle	Insufficient Qi/Blood + Qi/Yin/cold stagnation
Ding — boil/furuncle	Exogenous wind-fire toxins, surface heat
Jie — furuncle	Stagnated Qi/Blood from damp-heat in skin

10 · Secretions/Excretions Logic

Applies to nasal discharge, sputum, stool, vaginal discharge alike.

Axis	Cold/Deficient	Hot/Excess
Color	White	Yellow
Consistency	Thin, clear, watery	Thick, sticky
Quantity	Profuse	Scanty
Odor	None/faint	Strong

Quick Recall: White/thin/profuse/no-odor = cold-deficiency. Yellow/thick/scanty/strong-odor = heat-excess.

11 · Infant Finger Venous Diagnosis

Age <3. Left index finger=boys, right index finger=girls.

Gate Reached	Severity
Wind Gate only	Mild illness / exterior pathogen
Qi Gate	Interior condition, stronger illness
Life Gate	Severe illness
Past Life Gate to tip	Life-threatening

Vein Color	Indication
Light red, not very visible	Normal
Bright red	Heat
Purple	Stronger heat, creating stasis
Green or dark blue	Wind

Recognition Traps — Common Miscalls

Trap	Correct Discriminator
Red throat = always excess	Chronic, dry, NOT swollen red throat can be Yin-deficiency empty heat instead
Open mouth = always excess	Open + fever/thirst = excess heat. Open + SOB/frothy sputum = Lung deficiency with phlegm
Purple lips = only cold	Purple can also mean Blood stasis (stabbing pain) — check for cold signs vs. stasis signs to distinguish
"Slow movement + cold" = Yin deficiency	It's Yang deficiency. Yin deficiency causes HEAT signs (five-center heat, night sweats), not cold
Any yellow finding = heat	Yellow = damp/deficiency in general; only bright/orange yellow leans heat-predominant. Dull/dark yellow leans cold-damp
Nail bed blanch test: any return = normal	Immediate return = sufficient Qi/Blood. SLOW return = exhaustion of Qi/Blood — the speed is the diagnostic
Eye wheel Kidney = Right Chi pulse Kidney	Separate systems. Eye Water Wheel (pupil) = Kidney, but Right Chi PULSE position = Pericardium/San Jiao
Left/right cheek = your left/right as viewer	Su Wen 32 uses the PATIENT'S own left/right. Face-forward pictures are mirrored

Heads Up — Quiz Move — For every local sign, work it in this order: **color/shape → thermal nature → excess/deficiency → organ/channel → one confirming symptom**. Same 5-step logic tested across every section in this kit.

12 · Constitutional Types (Flagged)

Heads Up — Scope conflict: Prof. Lao's recorded lecture says **"Nothing on the body constitutions"** will be tested. Prof. Schrier's own deck devotes ~9/41 slides to it. Confirm with him which governs the quiz.

Weak vs. Strong Constitution (Ling Shu 54)

Marker	Weak	Strong
Eyes/nose/ears/mouth	Close together	Well-proportioned
Space between eyebrows	Small	Broad forehead/glabella
Nose	Narrow, flared	Straight, well-formed
Philtrum	Short	Long
Cheeks	Thin	Full, normal luster
Jaw	Flat, sunken, narrow	Strong, even, smooth
Ears	Small, short lobes	Long, long lobes
Muscles/skin	Flabby, loose	Firm

Cause of Weak Constitution
Parents' general health
Health at time of conception
Mother's health during pregnancy
Parental age/pregnancy events (stress, trauma, drugs/alcohol/smoking)
Heads Up — Constitution is not fixed: Pre-Heavenly (Jing) essence is the basis; Post-Heavenly Qi (diet, herbs, acupuncture, <i>yang sheng</i>) can improve it.

Five-Element Body Types (Ling Shu 64)

Element	Physical	Personality
Wood	Green complexion, small head, long face, broad shoulders, tall, sinewy	Superior talent, hardworking, survives sickness
Fire	Red complexion, small head/hands/feet, curly/little hair, walks fast+sways	Frivolous w/ wealth, passionate, impulsive, curious
Earth	Yellow complexion, round face, big head, wide jaws, large abdomen	Dignified, calm, unassertive, likes helping people
Metal	Pale complexion, square face, flat abdomen, strong voice	Honest, upright, rational, leadership aptitude
Water	Dark complexion, big head, wrinkles, round body, swaying gait	Laid-back, unafraid, tendency to deceive, always moving

Quick Recall: Wood=tall/hardworking. Fire=curly/impulsive. Earth=round/calm. Metal=square/honest. Water=dark/deceptive.